ORDER
7110.3B

Effective Date:
March 19, 2026

SUBJ: BIL ATCT/TRACON Standard Operating Procedures

This document establishes the Billings Airport Traffic Control Tower and Terminal Radar Approach Control (BIL ATCT/TRACON) Standard Operating Procedures within the Salt Lake City ARTCC on VATSIM (vZLC). Controllers are required to be familiar with the provisions of this document and to exercise their best judgment if they encounter situations not covered by it. The provisions and procedures described herein are supplemental to vZLC Facility Policy and FAA Order JO 7110.65.

The information contained herein is to be used for flight simulation purposes only on the VATSIM network. It is not intended, nor should it be used for real-world navigation. The Virtual Salt Lake City ARTCC is not affiliated with the FAA, the actual Salt Lake City ARTCC, or any governing aviation body.

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Record of Changes

Version	Description	Effective Date	Issued By
7110.3A	Initial Release	05/03/2025	HL
7110.3B	Addition Of SAID System	03/19/2026	AE

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Chapter 1. General Control

Section 1. Introduction

1-1-1. Purpose
This document establishes the Billings Airport Traffic Control Tower and Terminal Radar Approach Control (BIL ATCT/TRACON) Standard Operating Procedures within the Salt Lake City ARTCC on VATSIM (vZLC).

1-1-2. Audience
All vZLC controllers and visitors contained within the vZLC and VATUSA roster.

1-1-3. Distribution
This document is authorized for unrestricted use and release and is available in the Resources Section of the vZLC Website.

1-1-4. Cancellation
This document cancels BIL ATCT SOP (7110.3A), effective May 3, 2025.

Section 2. Operational Positions

Table 1-2-1. BIL ATCT/TRACON Operational Positions Table

Sector/Position	STARS ID	VATSIM Callsign	Frequency
Ground Control (GC)	**X**	**BIL_GND**	**121.900**
Local Control (LC)	**T**	**BIL_TWR**	**127.200**
Radar North (RN)	**N**	**BIL_N_APP**	**119.200**
Radar South (RS)	S	BIL_S_APP	120.500

Bold designates a primary position.

Section 3. Intrafacility Coordination Procedures

1-3-1. Runway Configurations

The active runway configuration refers to the general cardinal direction of departures and arrivals currently in use. Authorized runway configurations are listed in subparagraphs c. and d.

a. When selecting a runway configuration, the following factors must be considered:
   (1) Wind direction.
   (2) Wind speed. The gust factor takes precedence over the constant wind speed.
b. West Flow is designated as the "calm wind" runway configuration.
c. East Flow: Landing and departing Runway 10L and Runway 10R. Runway 7 may be issued at pilot request.
d. West Flow: Landing and departing Runway 28L and Runway 28R. Runway 25 may be issued at pilot request.

1-3-2. Changing Runway Configurations

The Local Control (LC) position is the final authority for selecting the runway configuration, but coordination with GC and TRACON must be accomplished prior to changing the runway configuration.

a. LC must:
   (1) Coordinate with GC and TRACON to determine which aircraft will be the last departure and arrival in the old runway configuration.
   (2) Coordinate with GC to determine the appropriate status of Runway 7/25, in accordance with paragraph 2-1-6.
   (3) Ensure that:
      (a) The Tower Display Workstation (STARS) display is adjusted to indicate the correct flow.
      (b) The ATIS is updated to reflect the runway configuration change.
b. TRACON must:
   (1) Ensure the STARS display is adjusted to indicate the correct flow.
   (2) Notify ZLC ARTCC Sectors 15 and 39 (or other appropriate overlying sector) of the runway configuration change.

1-3-3. ATIS

Regardless of the position broadcasting the ATIS, the following statements must be included on the ATIS broadcast:

a. During VFR weather conditions: "DEPARTING VFR AIRCRAFT ADVISE GROUND CONTROL OF REQUESTED HEADING OR DESTINATION."
b. When the outside air temperature is 26°C or greater: "CHECK DENSITY ALTITUDE."

   NOTE-
   This statement must be made immediately after stating the altimeter setting.

1-3-4. Airfield Pavement Weight Limitations

To the maximum extent possible, avoid having any aircraft weighing more than 12,500 lbs. use Runway 7/25 as an exit for Runway 10L/28R.

1-3-5. Taxiway H Jurisdiction

The position that has control jurisdiction of Runway 7/25 must also have jurisdiction of that portion of Taxiway H west of Runway 7/25 (see paragraph 2-1-6).

Section 4. LC-TRACON Coordination Procedures

1-4-1. IFR Departure Corridors

IFR Departure Corridors are activated based on the runway flow currently in use and provide LC with a “fan” of headings to release IFR departures on. IFR Departure Corridors are depicted in Appendix 1, extending from the surface up to 7,000 feet MSL. The following procedures must be adhered to when utilizing departure corridors:

a. Only one departure corridor may be active at any time.

   NOTE-
   An operation to a non-advertised runway does not activate a new/additional departure corridor.

b. Aircraft departing through the corridor may operate immediately adjacent to the lateral boundaries from the surface up to the ceiling of the corridor. Assigned headings from LC must not allow the aircraft’s target to touch the corridor boundary.

c. Aircraft under the control of TRACON must maintain the following separation from the corridor lateral boundaries:
   (1) IFR aircraft - 3NM.
   (2) VFR aircraft - must not touch the corridor boundary.

d. The radar map for the active departure corridor must be displayed on all radar displays.

1-4-2. Departure Procedures

For all departing aircraft, the following procedures must be adhered to:

a. LC must:
   (1) Have automatic (rolling) departure releases on all IFR aircraft departing through the departure corridor (see paragraph 1-4-1), unless cancelled by TRACON.

   NOTE-
   1. *TRACON may cancel automatic departure releases at any time. Unless explicitly stated by TRACON and acknowledged by LC, automatic departure releases are assumed to be in use.*
   2. *A rolling call is required to be sent to the appropriate departure controller. The preferred method for sending a rolling call is utilizing the .RC command (see the ZLC Alias Command Reference).*

   (2) Provide initial separation between all departing aircraft.
   (3) Assign initial headings to all IFR aircraft in accordance with Table 1-4-1 and to all VFR aircraft in accordance with Table 1-4-2.

Table 1-4-1. IFR Initial Headings

Type	Runway	Authorized Heading(s)
Turbojet	10L/R	102°
	28L/R	282°-320°
Non-Turbojet	10L/R	060°-140°
	28L/R	240°-320°

Table 1-4-2. VFR Initial Headings

Type	Runway	Authorized Heading(s)
Turbojet	10L/R	102°
	28L/R	282°-360°
Non-Turbojet	10L/R	360°-180°
	28L/R	180°-360°

(4) Coordinate with TRACON if a departure does not auto-acquire within 2 NM of the airport.

(5) Transfer communications to TRACON within 3 NM of the departure end of the runway.

b. TRACON must:

(1) Have control for climbs and turns on initial contact.

(2) Verbally coordinate with LC when cancelling automatic departure releases.

1-4-3. Arrival Procedures

For all arriving aircraft, the following procedures must be adhered to:

a. LC must:

(1) Have control of arrivals on initial contact. If LC issues control instructions that affect the sequence, LC assumes responsibility for separation and must coordinate with TRACON.

NOTE-

Coordination may be verbal or via STARS scratchpad.

(2) Advise TRACON of aircraft executing an unplanned missed approach/go-around and comply with paragraph 1-4-4.

b. TRACON must:

(1) Sequence all arrivals to BIL airport except for VFR aircraft handed off to LC.

(2) Ensure separation of arrivals to the runway threshold.

NOTE-
If LC issues control instructions that affect the sequence, LC assumes responsibility for separation and must coordinate with TRACON.

(3) Transfer communications to LC between 5 NM and 15 NM from the airport.
(4) Hand off all VFR arrivals to LC prior to the LC airspace boundary (see Appendix 1).
(5) When vectoring to the final approach course(s) for a single runway, parallel runways, or crossing runways, ensure the existence of vertical separation between opposite direction base leg traffic until another form of separation is established.
(6) Provide IFR separation services to VFR aircraft conducting practice approaches, in accordance with FAA JO 7110.65, paragraphs 4-8-11.a.(2) and 5-5-4.

c. TRACON may vector aircraft for a visual approach when the reported ceiling is 2,100 feet or greater and the visibility is 3 miles or greater.

1-4-4. Missed Approach/Go-Around
IFR aircraft executing an unplanned missed approach/go-around must comply with the following procedures:

a. Aircraft not on a visual approach may:
   (1) Fly the published missed approach procedure, or;
   (2) Be assigned a heading in accordance with Table 1-4-1 and an altitude of 7,000 feet.
b. Aircraft on a visual approach may:
   (1) Be assigned a heading in accordance with Table 1-4-1 and an altitude of 7,000 feet, or;
   (2) Join the local traffic pattern, in accordance with FAA JO 7110.65, paragraph 7-4-1.

Table 1-4-1. Missed Approach/Go-Around Headings

Runway	Authorized Heading(s)
10L/R	290°-090°
7, 25, 28L/R	Any

1-4-5. IFR Practice Approaches
TRACON must issue the following missed approach instructions to IFR aircraft conducting multiple practice approaches:

a. Runway 10L: Heading 090° and 7,000 feet
b. Runway 28R: Heading 280° and 7,000 feet

Section 5. Automation

1-5-1. Use of Tower Display Workstation (TDW)

LC must quick-look all TRACON positions. Arrival data from TRACON to LC must be transferred through the use of quick-look.

1-5-2. Altitude Filter Limits

All radar positions must monitor all aircraft altitudes to include up to at least:

a. TRACON: FL200.
b. LC: 8,000 feet. The lower limit may be temporarily adjusted to no higher than 3,800 feet when target clutter is excessive.

1-5-3. STARS Automated Point-Out Procedures

The STARS automated Point-Out function is authorized between all BIL positions in accordance with the following procedures. The initiating controller must ensure:

a. The data block contains accurate scratchpad, type aircraft, and valid Mode-C altitude information.
b. Any requested and/or assigned altitude information contained in the data block is accurate prior to, and not changed after initiating, the point-out. Any changed information after acceptance of the point-out must be re-coordinated.
c. Altitude information for point-outs from LC must be considered to be “at or below” altitudes. Altitude information for point-outs from TRACON must be considered to be “at or above” altitudes.

Section 6. Opposite Direction Operations (ODO)

1-6-1. General

Opposite Direction Operations consist of IFR/VFR operations conducted to the same or parallel runway where an aircraft is operating in a reciprocal direction of another aircraft arriving, departing, or conducting an approach.

NOTE-
Departing aircraft include aircraft conducting a touch-and-go, stop-and-go, low approach, missed approach, or go-around.

1-6-2. Responsibilities

a. LC and TRACON share the responsibility to coordinate ODO and issue traffic advisories (see below).
b. LC is responsible for applying the cutoff point between opposite direction arriving and departing aircraft.
c. TRACON is responsible for applying the cutoff point between opposite direction arrival aircraft.

1-6-3. IFR Aircraft Procedures

a. General:
    (1) Traffic advisories must be issued to all ODO aircraft.

    PHRASEOLOGY-
    OPPOSITE DIRECTION TRAFFIC (distance) MILE FINAL, (type aircraft).
    OPPOSITE DIRECTION TRAFFIC DEPARTING RUNWAY (number), (type aircraft).
    OPPOSITE DIRECTION TRAFFIC (position), (type aircraft).

    (2) VFR aircraft conducting practice approaches must receive IFR services.
    (3) Opposite direction, same or parallel runway, operations with opposing traffic inside the cutoff point are prohibited.
    (4) Lateral separation must exist before any other type of separation is applied.
b. Coordination:
    (1) LC must verbally request opposite direction departures with TRACON.
    (2) TRACON must verbally request opposite direction arrivals with LC.
    (3) Initial coordination must include callsign, type, and arrival/departure runway. The phrase “opposite direction” must be used.
    (4) TRACON must enter the runway in the scratchpad for all ODO arrivals.
c. Cutoff procedures for aircraft conducting ODO to the same runway:

    NOTE-
    When both aircraft are receiving IFR services, visual separation is not authorized.

(1) A departing aircraft must be airborne and have turned to avoid conflict prior to an aircraft reaching:
   (a) A point five flying miles from the threshold of the runway of intended landing or, if an aircraft is established in the traffic pattern, prior to that aircraft turning base leg.
   (b) If the above conditions are not met, action must be taken to ensure control instructions are issued to protect the integrity of the cutoff points.

(2) An arriving aircraft must cross the runway threshold prior to an aircraft reaching:
   (a) A point five flying miles from the threshold of the runway of intended landing or, if an aircraft is established in the traffic pattern, prior to that aircraft turning base leg.
   (b) If the above conditions are not met, action must be taken to ensure control instructions are issued to protect the integrity of the cutoff points.

d. Cutoff procedures for aircraft conducting ODO to parallel runways:
   (1) Provide a turn away from the opposing arriving traffic before the arrival is inside of the cutoff point to the other runway. The same cutoff points in subparagraph c. must apply.

   NOTE-
   1. *Visual separation of any type may be applied after the turn away from opposing traffic is issued.*
   2. *Prior to a pilot providing visual separation, a heading with at least 15° angular difference between the aircraft's flight paths must be assigned to ensure flight paths do not cross.*

1-6-4. VFR Aircraft Procedures

a. Ensure VFR aircraft are issued a turn to avoid conflict with the opposing IFR/VFR traffic.
b. During coordination, the phrase "opposite direction" must be used.
c. LC must issue traffic information to both aircraft and indicate the direction that the departure will turn (arrival/departure ODO) or the location of the opposing aircraft on final (arrival/arrival ODO).
d. TRACON must enter the runway in the scratchpad for all ODO arrivals.

Chapter 2. Operational Positions

Section 1. Ground Control (GC)

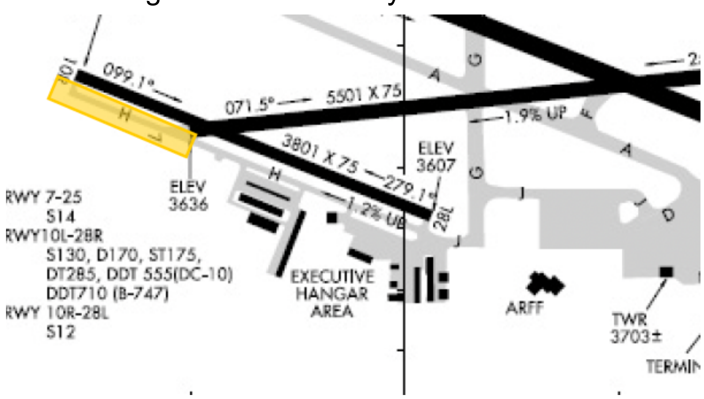
2-1-1. Position Responsibilities

a. Monitor the GC frequency (121.900 MHz).
b. Prepare, update, and mark flight progress strips in accordance with the ZLC Flight Strip Handling Directive (7210.3).
c. Issue departure clearances to IFR aircraft, complying with posted traffic management initiatives (TMIs), letters of agreement (LOAs), and published preferred routes.
d. Handle VFR departure aircraft in accordance with paragraph 2-1-4.
e. Ensure all taxiing aircraft have the current ATIS.
f. Determine/finalize aircraft departure runway assignments.
g. Assume other ground control or other cab responsibilities, as assigned.

2-1-2. Area of Jurisdiction

GC has jurisdiction of all taxiways in the movement area except that portion of Taxiway H west of Runway 7/25 (see Figure 2-1-1). When LC releases control of Runway 7/25 to GC (see paragraph 2-1-6), GC assumes control of that portion of Taxiway H west of Runway 7/25.

Figure 2-1-1. Taxiway H Jurisdiction



2-1-3. IFR Departure Instructions

Departing IFR aircraft must be assigned the following:

a. The latest rendition of the BIL# SID. If the pilot does not accept the SID, mark “NS” into Box 9 of the aircraft’s flight progress strip.
b. An initial altitude of 7,000 feet, or lower cruising altitude.

2-1-4. VFR Departure Instructions

All VFR aircraft that will depart the Class C surface area must:

a. Be issued both of the following:
    (1) Appropriate departure frequency.
    (2) Discrete beacon code.

b. Have the following filled out:
    (1) Flight Strip, in accordance with the ZLC Flight Strip Handling Directive (7210.3).
    (2) Flight Plan.

NOTE-
1. Aircraft that will not depart the Class C surface area (e.g. remaining in the traffic pattern) are not required to have any of the above, except a filled out Flight Strip.
2. A filled out Flight Plan indicates that the flight plan will be pushed to the NAS. This may be accomplished by using the Flight Plan Editor in CRC or by using the VP command in STARS.

2-1-5. Traffic Flow
GC must ensure all aircraft yield to aircraft exiting a runway, unless otherwise coordinated with LC.

2-1-6. Control of Runway 7/25
Runway 7/25 must be under the jurisdiction of LC by default. However, it is common for LC to release control of Runway 7/25 to GC when operationally advantageous. When GC requests control of Runway 7/25, verbal coordination must be accomplished in accordance with the following.

EXAMPLE-
To request control: "REQUEST CONTROL OF RUNWAY (number)."
To release control: "RUNWAY (number) RELEASED TO (position)."

NOTE-
Whichever position has control of Runway 7/25 must also have control of that portion of Taxiway H west of Runway 7/25 (see Figure 2-1-1). When coordination is accomplished to release control of Runway 7/25 to the other position, Taxiway H must be assumed to have also transferred control without any further coordination.

2-1-7. ATIS
Ensure all departure aircraft have the current ATIS.

2-1-8. Pushback Clearances
To the maximum extent possible, aircraft parked at the terminal ramp should push back within the non-movement area.

2-1-9. Use Of SAID System
a. SAID only displays ADS-B-equipped and transmitting aircraft/vehicles within the site-specific adapted area (the airport itself, not the surrounding area).
b. SAID systems may rely solely on ADS-B transponder information to display aircraft identification if NAS flight plan information is not available to the system. This may result in a discrepancy between SAID depicted aircraft identification and NAS flight plan

identification. This means that aircraft must have their ADS-B on with Altitude Reporting Enabled in order to move on the airport movement areas.

c. SAID-derived information may only be used for reference and requires confirmation via visual observation and/or pilot/operator reporting.
d. The SAID system does not use search patterns in a scratchpad box like ASDE-X.

Section 2. Local Control (LC)

2-2-1. Position Responsibilities

a. Monitor the LC frequency (127.200 MHz).
b. Provide control instructions to aircraft within the LC area of jurisdiction.
c. Determine the appropriate runway configuration in accordance with paragraph 1-3-1.
d. Sequence and separate departures and arrivals.
e. Operate TDW/STARS equipment, as necessary.
f. Mark FPSs in accordance with the ZLC Flight Strip Handling Directive (7210.3).
g. Assume other local control or other cab responsibilities, as assigned.

2-2-2. Area of Jurisdiction

LC has jurisdiction of the following:

a. LC airspace, as depicted in Appendix 1.
b. Runway 10L/28R.
c. Runway 10R/28L.
d. Runway 7/25, except when delegated to GC.
e. Taxiway H west of Runway 7/25, except when Runway 7/25 is delegated to GC.

2-2-3. Use of Radar

When using TDW/STARS, LC must:

a. Comply with the provisions contained within FAA JO 7110.65 Chapter 5.
b. Adjust the range of the radar to display a minimum of 15 NM.
c. Display the BIL Tower List.

2-2-4. Landing Clearance

The use of a memory aid upon issuance of landing clearance is mandatory. The preferred method for utilizing a landing clearance memory aid is by highlighting the aircraft's STARS Full Data Block (FDB).

Section 3. Radar North (RN)

2-3-1. Position Responsibilities

RN shall have the following responsibilities when operating the TRACON delegated airspace (see Appendix 2):

a. Ensure separation of aircraft.
b. Initiate, and ensure adequate readback of, control instructions.
c. Monitor and operate the Radar North frequency (119.200 MHz) as well as the Radar South (RS) frequency (120.500 MHz).
d. Accept and initiate handoffs, as necessary.
e. Coordinate with other control positions, as necessary.
f. Ensure scratchpad (and other STARS) entries are kept up-to-date, in accordance with ZLC Scratchpad Directive (7210.4).

2-3-2. Laurel Airport (6S8) Procedures

RN must adhere to the following procedures when handling air traffic at 6S8:

a. Aircraft requesting IFR clearance while still on the ground must be assigned the latest rendition of the BIL# SID.
b. Aircraft requesting IFR clearance in the air after departing 6S8 must be issued the clearance in accordance with FAA JO 7110.65, paragraph 4-2-8.d.
c. When in West Flow, coordinate any 6S8 arrivals conducting the RNAV (GPS) or VOR Runway 22 approach with LC. LC must hold all departure aircraft until the arrival is south of the Runway 10L/28R extended centerline (see Appendix 3).
d. IFR separation services must be provided to VFR aircraft conducting practice approaches, in accordance with FAA JO 7110.65, paragraphs 4-8-11.a.(2) and 5-5-4.

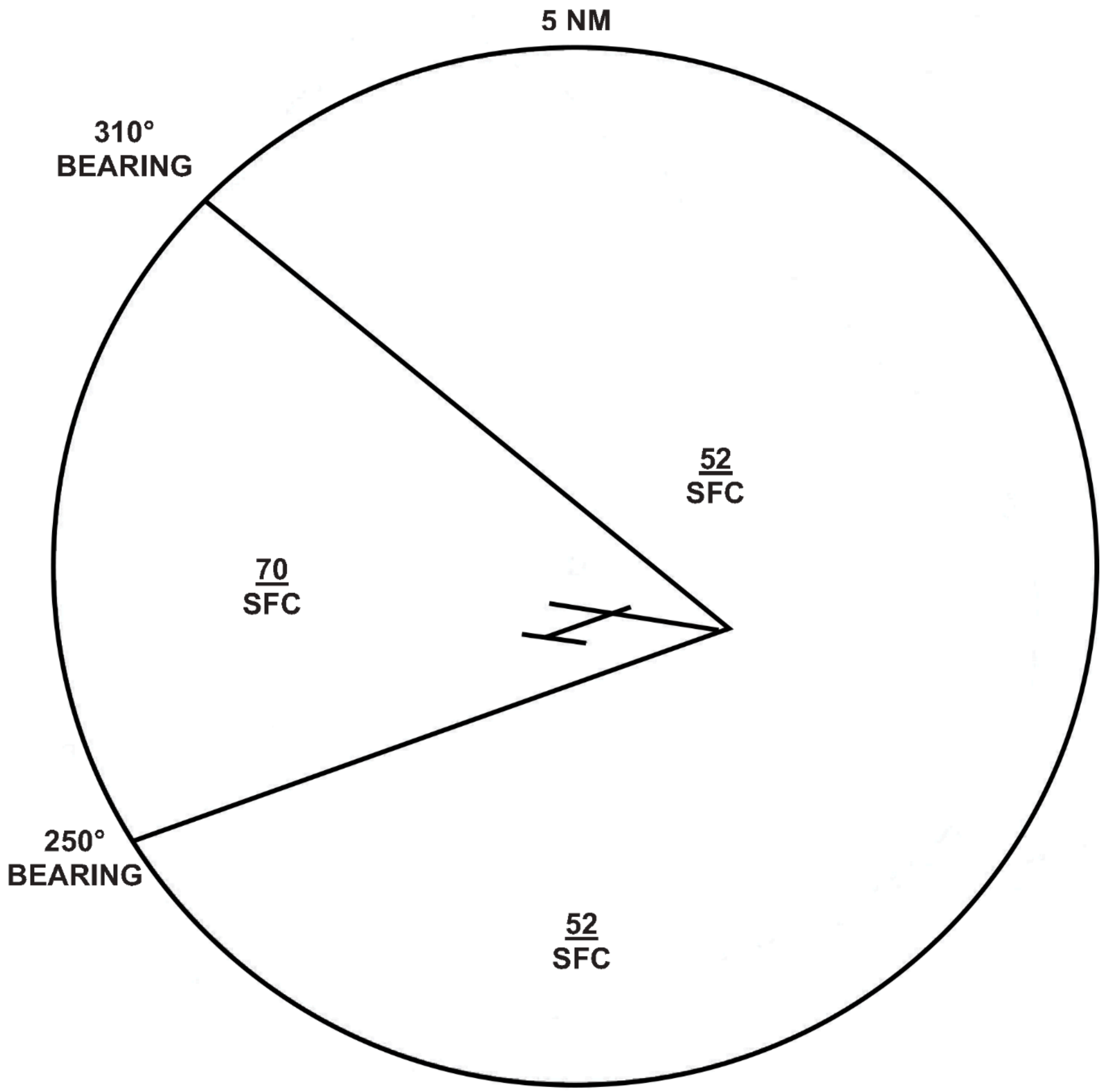
2-3-3. Radar South (RS)

While multiple TRACON positions exist (RN and RS), no split between positions exists. Therefore, RS must never be opened without explicit written permission from a ZLC Junior Staff or Senior Staff member, as defined in ZLC Facility Policy (7210.1).

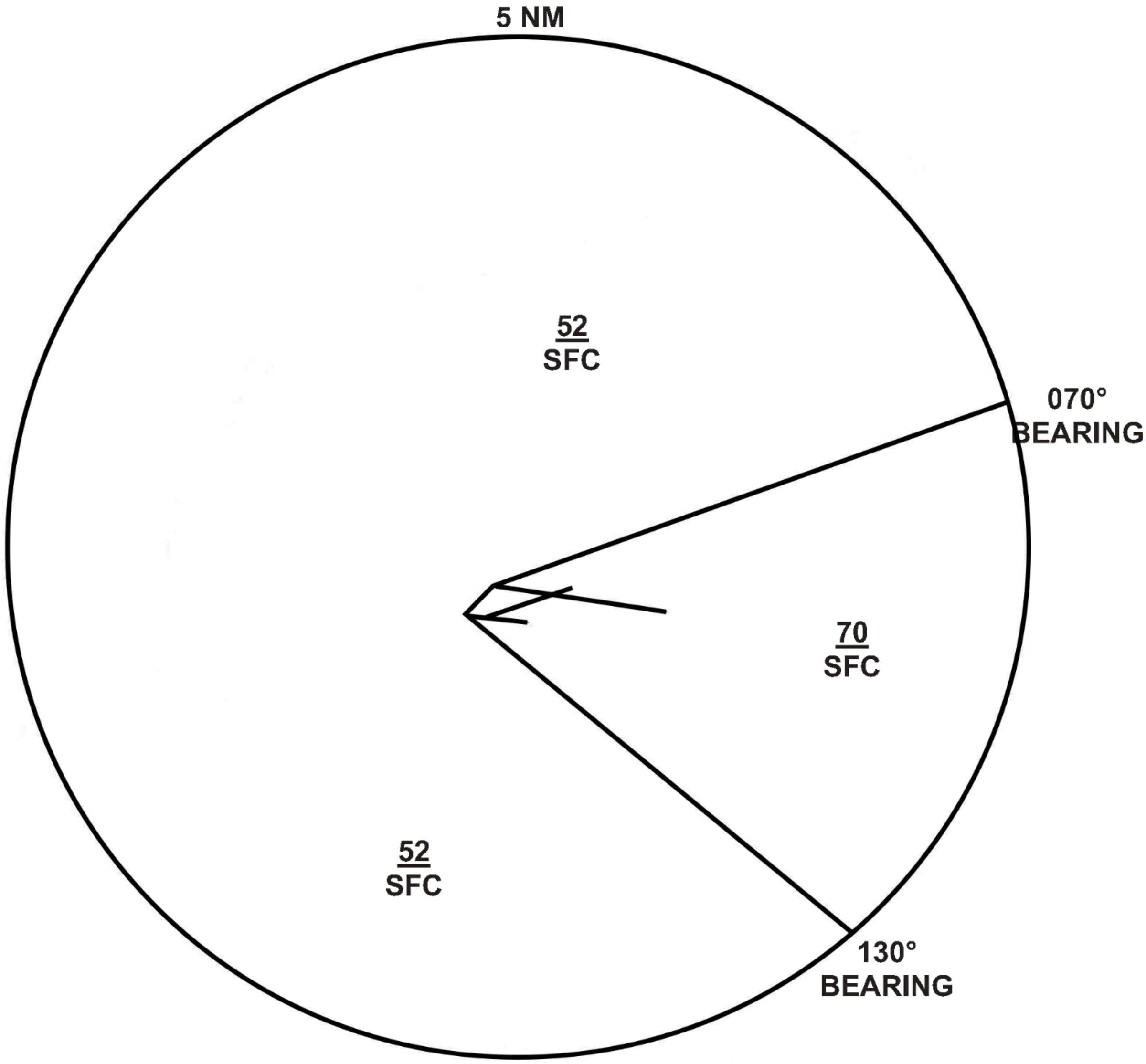
NOTE-
RS must still monitor the RN frequency when open. This is generally done automatically, but must still be verified when signing on to position.

Appendix 1. Local Control Airspace

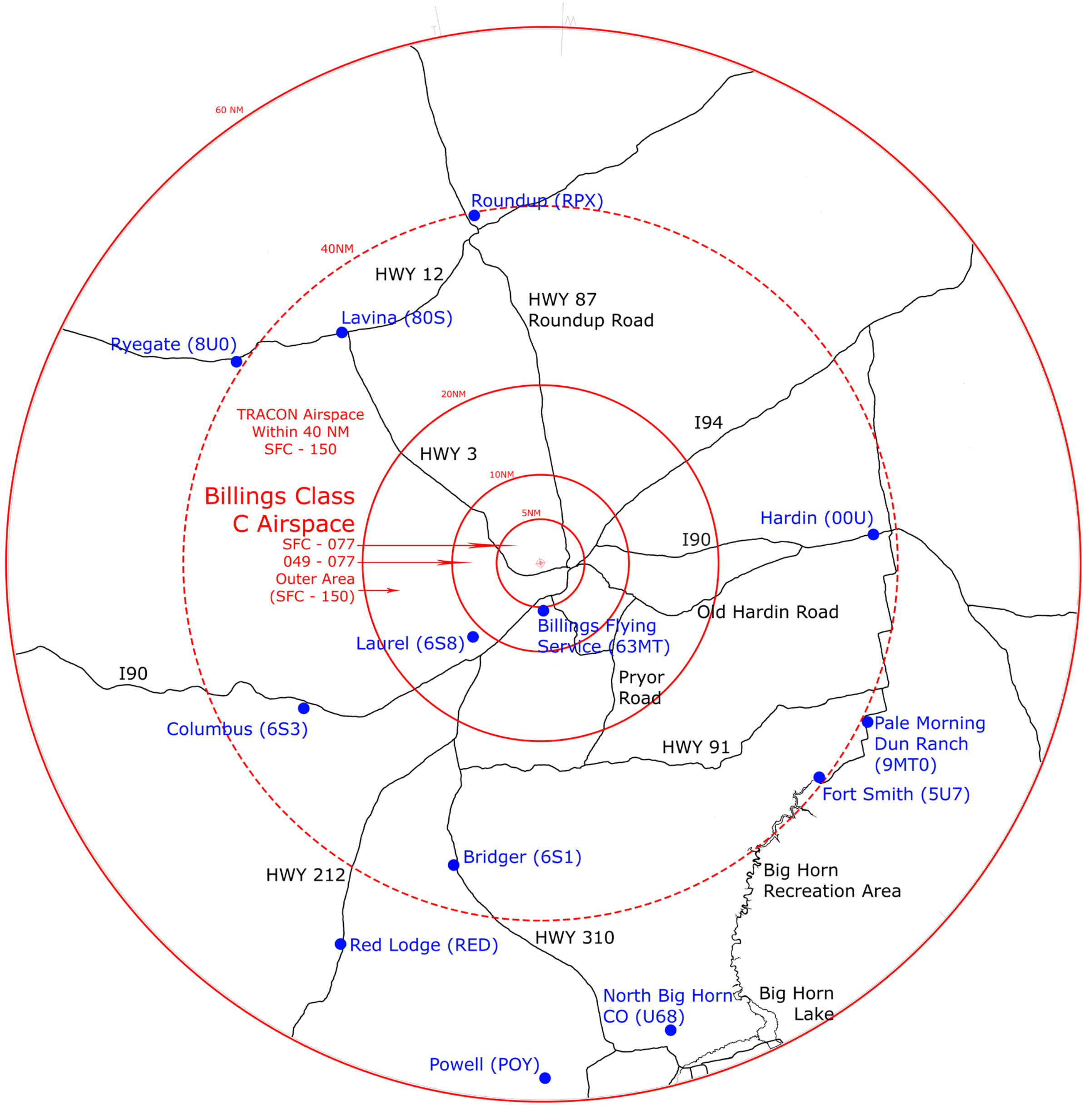
Appendix 1A. West Flow



Appendix 1B. East Flow



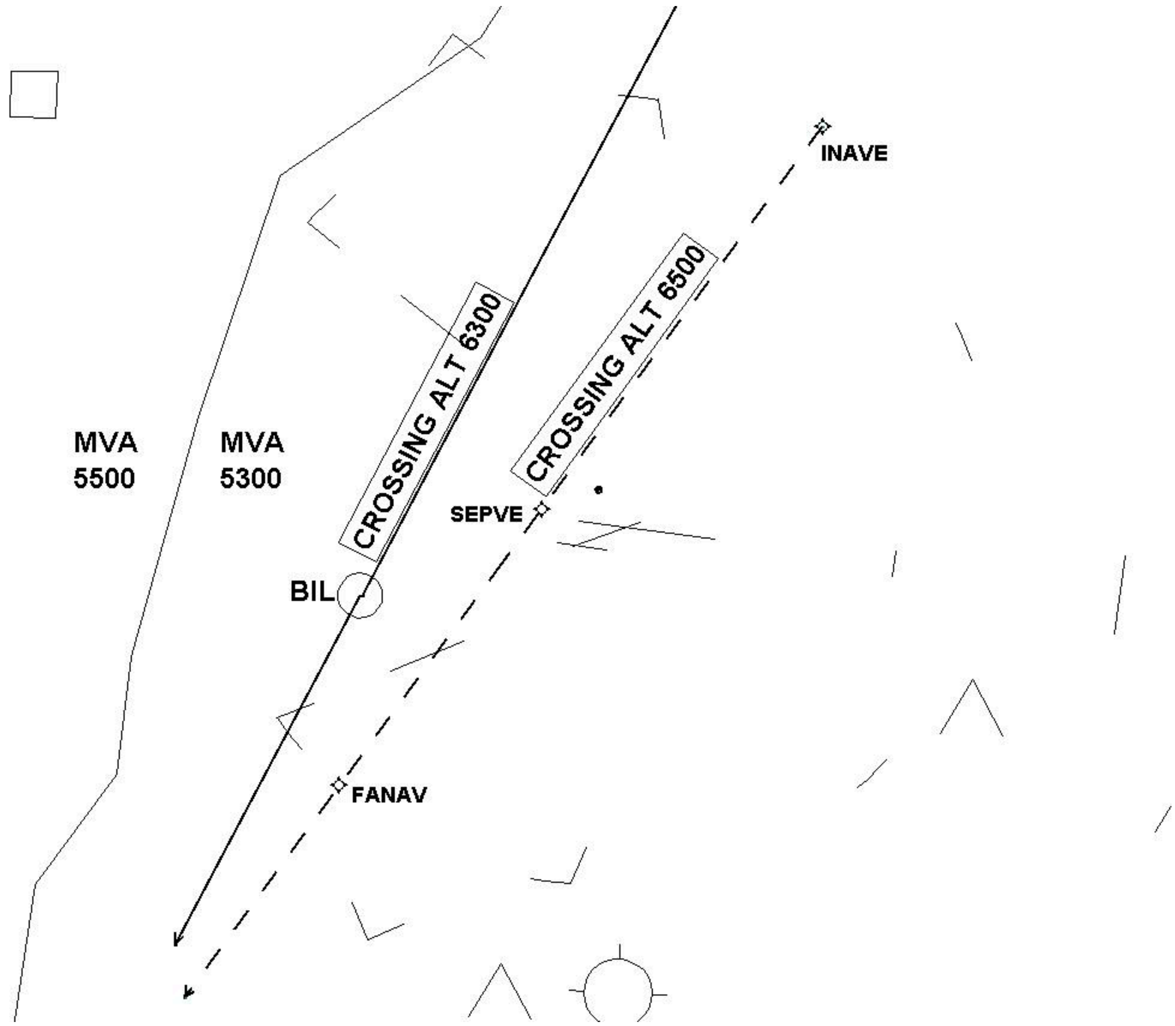
Appendix 2. TRACON Airspace



NOTE-

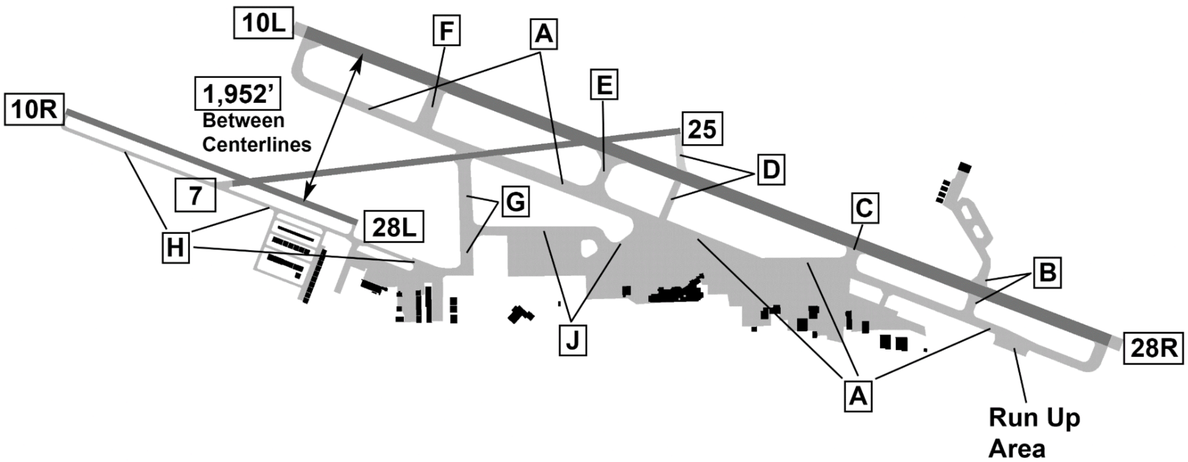
BIL ATCT/TRACON is delegated that airspace extending upward from the surface up to 15,000 feet MSL within a 40 NM radius of the defined coordinates for Billings Logan International Airport. The 60 NM ring displayed above is only to be interpreted for situational awareness.

Appendix 3. Laurel Airport (6S8) Runway 22 Approach Finals

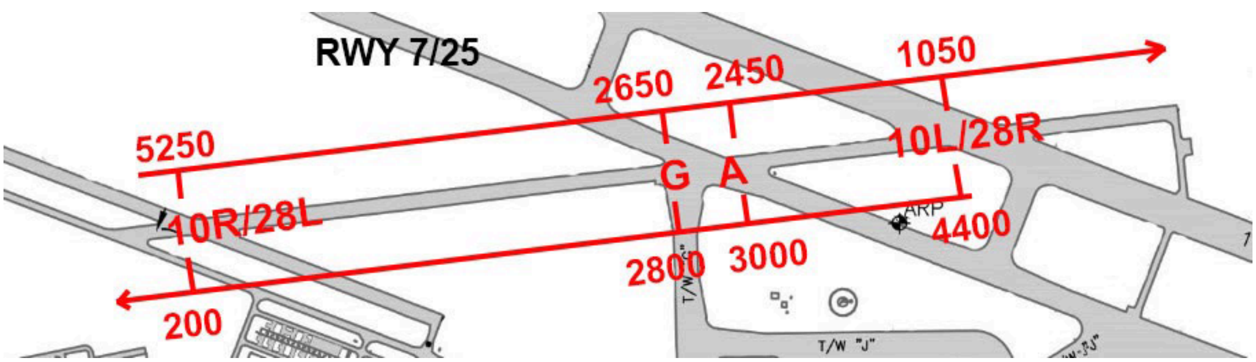


Appendix 4. BIL Airport Supplemental Information

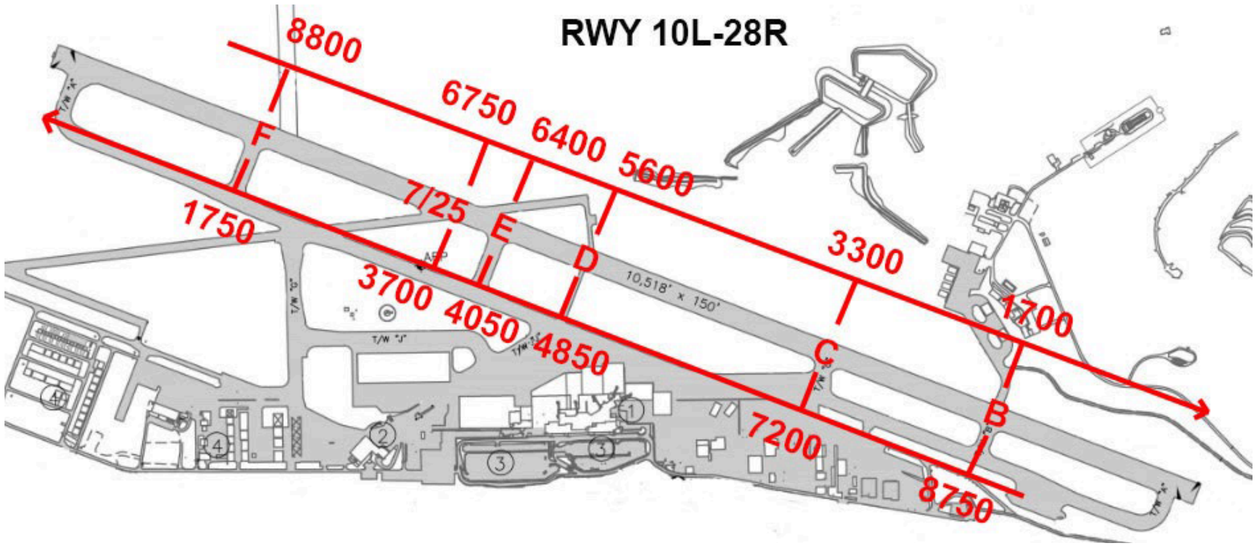
Appendix 4A. Taxiway Diagram



Appendix 4B. Runway 7/25 Distance Remaining Chart



Appendix 4C. Runway 10L/28R Distance Remaining Chart



Appendix 4D. Runway 10R/28L Distance Remaining Chart